

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 7 6 4

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 2

♣ A 8 4 3

♠ 5 3

♥ K 8 6 5

♦ A Q J 10 6 4

♣ K



♠ A 9

♥ A Q 9 3

♦ K 8 7 5

♣ J 6 5

♠ K J 10 8 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 3

♣ Q 10 9 7 2

West

North

East

South

1♦

All Pass

1♦ by North

Lead: ♣5

The bidding has been as shown. It is your turn.

Decide what you would say, then click on "" above.

You have 14 points but so what. You have no 5-card suit to Overcall. You cannot make a Takeout Double with 4 of their suit. So you pass. It is important to realize that there are hands you would open but cannot overcall with.

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 7 5 3
♥ K 10 9 3
♦ K 9 6 4
♣ 5

♠ K

♥ 8 6 2

♦ A 8 3 2

♣ A Q J 7 3



♠ 10 9 2

♥ A Q J 7 5

♦ Q J 7

♣ 8 6

♠ Q J 8 6 4

♥ 4

♦ 10 5

♣ K 10 9 4 2

The bidding has been as shown.

With four trumps and 12 points you have a text-book raise to 3♥. Partner had a minimum overcall though, so he passed.

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

1♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by East

Lead: ♦10

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6 5 2
♥ 10 6 4
♦ 10 9 2
♣ J 7

♠ A 7 4 3

♥ K 8 3

♦ 6 3

♣ 9 8 4 3



♠ Q J

♥ 9 2

♦ K Q J 4

♣ A K Q 10 2

♠ 10 9

♥ A Q J 7 5

♦ A 8 7 5

♣ 6 5

The bidding has been as shown.

With 12 points and a good suit you have a very solid overcall so you bid 1♥. Partner responds 2♥.

Partner is showing 6-10 points and three trumps. Your hand revalues to 14 at most so you pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

1♥

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by South

Lead: ♣J

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 9 7

♥ 8

♦ Q 6 2

♣ Q 9 4 3

♠ 10 8 5 4 3 2

♥ Q 7 6

♦ J 3

♣ J 10



♠ 6

♥ K J 9 4 3

♦ K 9 4

♣ 8 7 6 5

♠ A

♥ A 10 5 2

♦ A 10 8 7 5

♣ A K 2

The bidding has been as shown.

You really don't like partner's ♠s, and you do have 8 points. But 8 points is not enough to be considering game, and you would have to bid your ♥s at the 2-level. All things considered it is better to pass while you still aren't doubled.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by West

Lead: ♦ J

1 ♦

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 8 6 4

♥ 10 9

♦ 5

♣ A J 8 4 2

♠ 10 9

♥ K Q J 7 5 2

♦ Q J 7

♣ 6 5

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♠ Q 3

♥ 4

♦ K 9 8 6 4 3

♣ K Q 9 7

♠ J 7 5 2

♥ A 8 6 3

♦ A 10 2

♣ 10 3

West

1 ♠

All Pass

3 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣K

North

2 ♥

East

Pass

South

3 ♥

The bidding has been as shown.

You overcall 2 ♥ and hear partner raise you to 3 ♥.

No matter how many times you check this hand you cannot revalue it any more than 13 points. Since partner has 10 at the most you reluctantly pass.

Board 6

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 8 3
 ♥ A J 9 2
 ♦ 10 7
 ♣ 9 8 3 2

♠ Q 6 2

♥ 8 7 4

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ A Q 10



♠ A K 9 7 5

♥ K 10 3

♦ 9 5 3

♣ K 7

♠ 10 4

♥ Q 6 5

♦ K J 6 2

♣ J 6 5 4

The bidding has been as shown.

With only 7 points you might not think you have enough to make a "free bid". But in competitive bidding situations like these, where both sides have a fit, bidding is usually better than passing. So you bid 2♠.

You might look at the Law of Total Tricks lesson for more on this subject.

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

1♠

2♦

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by East

Lead: ♠10

Board 7

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5
 ♥ 10 7 6 2
 ♦ K J 9 2
 ♣ A J 6

♠ K 8 4 2

♥ A 9 3

♦ 10 5

♣ K Q 9 3



♠ A 7

♥ J 8 5

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ 10 7 5 4

♠ Q J 10 9 3

♥ K Q 4

♦ 8 6 3

♣ 8 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

Lead: ♥6

The bidding has been as shown.

You have enough for a 1-level Overcall so you bid 1♠. Partner says 3♠.

The jump raise tells you partner has 11-14 points.

With your minimum it's going to have to be better than that to get you excited. So you pass.

Board 8

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 6 4

♥ 3

♦ 9 8 6 2

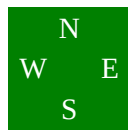
♣ J 8 2

♠ 9 2

♥ J 10 6 4

♦ K Q 10 7 4

♣ 10 6



♠ K 8 7 5 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A

♣ 7 5 4 3

♠ 10

♥ A K Q 9 8

♦ J 5 3

♣ A K Q 9

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

3 ♥

4 ♠

1 ♥

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥ J

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 10 points, but in cases like this points don't matter that much. They **MIGHT** be able to make 4 ♥. Partner **MIGHT** be able to make 4 ♠. This preemptive jump takes the decision away from them.

Looking at the hands you can see that partner is going to go down 1 at 4 ♠. However, that is an excellent result since they appear to be cold for 5 ♥.

Board 9

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 10 4
♥ 5
♦ Q 10 9
♣ K J 10 7 6

♠ 5 3
♥ A K 10 8 4
♦ K 6 3
♣ A 5 4



♠ 9 8 2
♥ J 6 2
♦ J 8 7 2
♣ Q 8 3

♠ A J 7 6
♥ Q 9 7 3
♦ A 5 4
♣ 9 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	1 ♥	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			
Lead: ♣ 3			

The bidding has been as shown.

Nice hand. But not nice enough to double, then bid your ♥s. So you overcall 1 ♥. Partner says 3 ♥.

The jump raise promises 11-14 points. Your 17 plus partner's 11 or so takes you right up to game. You bid 4 ♥.

Board 10

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7 2
♥ Q 8
♦ J 5 2
♣ A K J 9 7 2

♠ J 10 4

♥ J 9 3

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 8 5 4



♠ A K 5
♥ K 10 5 2
♦ 10 9 7 4
♣ Q 3

♠ Q 9 8 6 3

♥ A 7 6 4

♦ K Q

♣ 10 6

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has at least 11 points for his 2-level overcall. He might have as many as 16. You have a perfect invitational hand including two sure stoppers in their suit. So you bid 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT and you get to play it there.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♠
2 ♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♦ K			

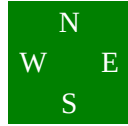
Board 11

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7 5
 ♥ 7 3 2
 ♦ 8 7 6 4 2
 ♣ 7 6

♠ A 8 3 2
 ♥ K J 10 6
 ♦ J 9 3
 ♣ 10 8



♠ K Q 9
 ♥ A 8 4
 ♦ A 10 5
 ♣ K Q 9 3

♠ J 6 4
 ♥ Q 9 5
 ♦ K Q
 ♣ A J 5 4 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♣	1NT
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♠ 7			

The bidding has been as shown.

This hand would be one point too strong to **Open** 1NT, but it fits the 15-18 range to **Overcall** 1NT. Partner responds 2 ♣.

Don't get your systems crossed. Partner did not make a cue-bid, he is using Stayman. Since you have no 4-card Major suit you answer 2 ♦. Partner now says 2NT and the ball is in your court.

This is just a plain old 1NT/Stayman sequence. Partner is inviting, and since you have 18 points you accept.

Board 12

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 10 7 5

♥ J 6

♦ 9 7 2

♣ Q 8 3

♠ 4

♥ 10 9 4 3

♦ Q J 4 3

♣ J 7 4 2



♠ Q 8 6 3

♥ A K Q 7

♦ 6 5

♣ K 10 6

♠ J 9 2

♥ 8 5 2

♦ A K 10 8

♣ A 9 5

The bidding has been as shown.

Wow! Great ♠ support and 15 points. You cue-bid 2♦, forcing partner to bid. He says 2♠. Your turn.

Partner has not made a strong bid and it is possible that 10 tricks will be too high. But it is pretty likely that game can be made so you bid it. Be bold!

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♦

1 ♦

2 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♦ Q

Board 13

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 5
♥ A J 10 9 7 3
♦ J 9
♣ A Q J 10

♠ K Q J 9 8 4

♥ 8 4

♦ Q 6 3

♣ 9 5



♠ A 6 3 2
♥ 5
♦ A 10 7 4 2
♣ K 6 3

♠ 10 7

♥ K Q 6 2

♦ K 8 5

♣ 8 7 4 2

West

1 ♥

All Pass

2 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ 5

North

2 ♠

*East**South*

The bidding has been as shown.

If you had been the dealer you would have opened 2 ♠. The situation is no different after they open so you Overcall 2 ♠. Everybody passes.

Board 14

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 5
 ♥ K Q J 9 7
 ♦ 8 3
 ♣ K 5 2

♠ 4 2

♥ A 10 8 6

♦ A J 10 9

♣ J 8 3



♠ A K J 8 6 3

♥ 3

♦ 6 5

♣ Q 10 7 6

♠ Q 10

♥ 5 4 2

♦ K Q 7 4 2

♣ A 9 4

The bidding has been as shown.

You don't like to take partner out of his overcalled suit without good reason. Here you have good reason. So you bid 1♠. Partner replies 2♠. What do you say next?

You expect partner to have three trumps, but he has made a minimum bid. So you take the conservative route and pass.

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	1♠	1♦
2♠			Pass
All Pass			
2♠ by East			
Lead: ♦K			

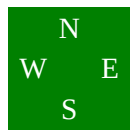
Board 15

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 2
 ♥ 10 7 2
 ♦ J 5
 ♣ A Q J 7 6 3

♠ 10 8 5
 ♥ A K J 8 4
 ♦ K 6 3
 ♣ 9 5



♠ 6 4
 ♥ 9 6 5 3
 ♦ Q 10 9 4
 ♣ K 8 2

♠ K Q J 9 7 3
 ♥ Q
 ♦ A 8 7 2
 ♣ 10 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1 ♣	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ J			

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a nice easy decision here. You overcall 1 ♥. Then partner bids 1 ♠. What do you say next?

Whether you play a change of suit as forcing or not, your hand certainly qualifies as one where you should make a bid. Partner doesn't really like your ♥s but you are quite satisfied to play in ♠s. So you bid 2 ♠. Partner jumps to 4 ♠ and that closes out the auction.

Board 16

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 10 9
 ♥ K 10 7 3
 ♦ A J 10
 ♣ A Q 5

♠ 6 2

♥ 9 4 2

♦ 9 7 4 3

♣ K J 8 3



♠ K Q 8 3

♥ A 8 6 5

♦ 6 5

♣ 10 7 6

♠ A 7 5 4

♥ Q J

♦ K Q 8 2

♣ 9 4 2

The bidding has been as shown.

You treat partner's 1NT Overcall the same as a 1NT Opening. You use Stayman and bid 2♣. Partner replies 2♥. What is your next bid?

You have 9 points, an invitational strength hand. You bid 3♥, inviting partner to go to game with a maximum. He declines your invitation.

West	North	East	South
			1♦
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♥	
All Pass			
3♥ by West			
Lead: ♠6			

Board 17

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K 7 5 3 2

♥ A 2

♦ J 6 2

♣ A 8 4

♠ A J 9

♥ 10 9 4

♦ K 3

♣ Q J 10 6 3



♠ Q 10 6

♥ 8 7 6 5 3

♦ 10 8 7 4

♣ 5

♠ 8 4

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q 9 5

♣ K 9 7 2

West

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ 10

North

2 ♣

2NT

East

Pass

Pass

South

2 ♠

3NT

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a sound 2-level overcall. You bid 2 ♣ and partner replies 2 ♠. What is your next bid?

Partner's cue-bid obviously forces you to bid.

Partner's hand might be very distributional, but rather than just sticking to ♣s you suggest with 2NT. This guarantees you have ♠s stopped. Partner likes your suggestion and bids 3NT.

Board 18

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q J 10 5

♥ Q 10 7

♦ A J 3

♣ 8 7

♠ 9 4 2

♥ 8 5 4 2

♦ 8 6 2

♣ 5 4 2



♠ 8 3

♥ A J 9

♦ K Q 9 7

♣ Q J 10 6

♠ A 7 6

♥ K 6 3

♦ 10 5 4

♣ A K 9 3

The bidding has been as shown.

Balanced hand, poor support for partner's suit, stoppers in their suit and 13 points. You couldn't get a better hand to jump to 2NT. Partner takes you to 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2NT

1 ♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♣K

Board 19

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 6 5
 ♥ A 9 6 2
 ♦ 3
 ♣ A J 8 5 3

♠ 8 3

♥ K 8 5

♦ K Q 10 9 6 4

♣ 7 2



♠ Q 9 7 4 2

♥ J 4 3

♦ J 8 2

♣ 6 4

♠ A J 10

♥ Q 10 7

♦ A 7 5

♣ K Q 10 9

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	2 ♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♣5			

The bidding has been as shown.

With a good 6-card suit and 10 points you make a Weak Jump Overcall to 2 ♦. Partner says 2NT.

The 2NT bid is a standard response to a Weak 2-bid. It asks for the identification of any outside high-card if the Weak 2-bidder has more than a minimum. Here you are in the top range for your bid so you show your ♥K.

That was apparently the missing link for partner, he now says 3NT.

Board 20

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 10 9 3 2

♥ 8 4 2

♦ A 7

♣ 9 2

♠ 6 4

♥ J 10 9 6 3

♦ Q 10 8 4

♣ Q 7



♠ A 8 5

♥ A K 7

♦ K J 6

♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ J 7

♥ Q 5

♦ 9 5 3 2

♣ A K J 5 3

*West**North**East**South*

2 ♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3 ♦

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥ J

The bidding has been as shown.

You might just try 4 ♠. Of course if partner has a minimum Weak Jump Overcall that will get you much too high. A better approach is to ask for more information from partner. The bid that asks is 2NT. Partner replies 3 ♦.

Partner's 3 ♦ bid tells you two things. One, he is in the top half of his 6-11 point range. Two, he has a high card (Ace or King) in ♦s. When you construct a hand for him which contains 6 pretty good ♠s and the ♦ A you come up with a hand which will probably make game. Bid 4 ♠.